A knife can be designed for chopping, tearing, dicing, spreading, carving and slicing. It depends on the blade of the knife, whether it is pointed, blunt and serrated.

Dull blades are used to cut soft or cooked food. Serrated knives are used to cut and part fruits. Knife with a broad flat blade is suitable for eating fish while knife with blunt ends is used to spread butter, cheese spread and marmalades.

Knives can be classified according to its size and use.

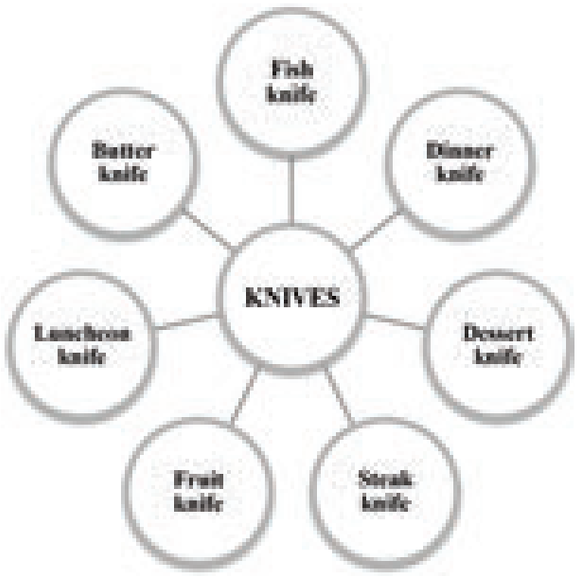


Figure 3.2 Types of Knives

- **Dinner knife:** The size is between 9½ and 10 inches and is used to cut and push food.
- **Steak knife:** It can be used in place of dinner knife, serrated or non-serrated depending on specific steak cuts and 4 to 6 inches long.
- **Dessert knife:** It can be used for dessert, fresh or candied fruits. This can be used to cut cakes and pastries.
- **Fruit knife:** It measures around 6½ to 7½ inches. It has a pointed tip and a narrow straight. The blade can be serrated or slightly curved and meant to cut and peel fruits.
- **Luncheon knife:** It is slightly smaller than dinner knife to suit the size of the luncheon plate for meals.
- **Fish knife:** It measures 8¾ inches with a wide blade and dull edge. It helps to slide between the skin and flesh of the fish, the broad blade assists in lifting the fish to the fork.
- **Butter knife:** It is small in size, measures 5 to 6 inches. It has a rounded point to avoid damage to the bread while spreading butter.



Plate 3.30 Dinner Knife



Plate 3.31 Steak Knife



Plate 3.32 Dessert Knife



Plate 3.33 Fruit Knife

FSM_Chapter 03.indd 53 1/13/2020 9:49:40 AM